

I arrived at my friends John's place a little after 6 am and it was already apparent we were in for some fun. The sky was crystal clear but only because the wind that gusted through the area. As we drove to the trailhead we could feel the wind pushing the car around on the freeway and dust clouds being swept across Riverside.

As we got closer to the trailhead we started to notice snow on the ground on some of the surrounding hills. Sure enough

Out came the cold gear





The hike up to Baden-Powell wasn't too bad. The trees generally protected us from the wind and the snow was light enough there were only a few places where you had to be careful not to slip. Of course a slip could easily result in quite a fall and I was dearly hoping that the ice would melt before we had to come down that way.



We kept a fair pace and before long we were at the saddle. The bump in the background is the actual Peak of Baden-Powel. As we cleared the trees it was a relief to see the ground was clear but now we were assaulted by the full force of the wind.





One of the interesting bits was the ice crystals on the trees. We kept getting showered by them every time we walk under one.





It was cold up top and I was in a hurry to keep moving before the sweat from the climb caused me to freeze. My calf, which I had been worried about during the climb, had loosed up at this point and I decided to continue.

The rest of the hike was 5.5 miles round trip and we would descend and then climb about 2,000 ft. The far hill in the center of the picture above is Ross, our goal.





The descent was very very steep at times though it did level out nicely while we crossed the bump in the middle.



We continued to pick our way down a use trail. I had to keep one hand on my hat for most of the hike to keep it from blowing away.





This is part of our group at Ross peak. The mountain in the background is Baden-Powell where we came from.



Finally we were back on Badel-Powell. The wind continued to pound on us and it was quite cool for everyone but Peter (far left of the picture.)

My ankle was doing better now either from using the hiking poles or the Advil but I still remained in the back of our group for the descent. The icy spots had mostly melted and so we had a nice descent.

At the half way point I was towards the back of our group talking with Bill when we came across a young woman with a backpacking pack on. She was using a cell phone and asked us if we had time to help. She told us there was an elderly couple who had made the peak and then the man had run into trouble coming down. He was 72 years old and apparently not doing very well. She had reached them briefly on her cell but didn't know exactly where they were.

Bill went with her back towards Baden-Powell and I continued down. A short time later I caught sight of the rest of the group on switchback down. There were two unfamiliar people with them one of which, an older male, was swaying strangely.

This is all pieces together from later but apparently the younger woman was their daughter and was training to hike the Grand Canyon. Her parents decided to help her by hiking Baden-Powell, a 8 mile 2,800 ft of climbing round trip. She daughter had gone down ahead to use the restroom and at some point the man became weak.

They called the daughter on the cell phone and she started up. Somehow she managed to pass her parents on the trail because when I came across her she was already above them. We were eventually able to get enough cell reception to let her and Bill know to come down and contact medical assistance for the man.

The gentleman was 72 years old and was constantly swaying back and forth. Our group had one person in front and one behind to make sure he didn't pitch off the edge of the trail. We gave him Bill's hiking poles and that seemed to help a little. The problem was at the rate he was traveling it would be some time before we could get him off the mountain.

John and I took off down the trail to direct the paramedics when they arrived. Somehow someone with a dirt bike showed up and drove up the trail to try and render assistance but returned not long after.

The forest service emergency vehicle was the first to arrive. 5 EMTs spoke to us and hiked up the trail but they had no stretcher in their vehicle.

A helicopter soon arrived but after hovering above us briefly it started flying back and forth. John started waving and eventually they landed and dropped off one person and some luggage before taking off again.

We were able to tell this person which trail the person in trouble was on



